

How qualities add up

Value, quality, and different varieties

Gems are defined by the very qualities that give them their value (see pp.30–31) – a gem would not be a gem without some level of material purity and craftsmanship. However, not all gems are equal.

COMPARATIVE GEM VALUES

The chart below compares a selection of popular gemstones according to their approximate monetary value (see p.27 for information on valuing diamonds, not included here). Varieties such as alexandrite, sapphire, and ruby are scarce and sought-after, and thus expensive; others, such as ruby, can vary hugely in cost, from modest to priceless. In general, the greater the clarity, size, and beauty of colour, the more you will pay.

